

	Steps	Rational
1.	Identify patient correctly	To do the correct procedure to right patient
2.	Wash hands and wear PPE	To prevent infection
3.	Explain procedure to patient	Reduce anxiety and gain patient help
4.	Remove dressing covering the chest tube insertion site	
5.	Using sterile technique, wrap petroleum gauze around the chest tube insertion site.	
6.	Place a precut. Sterile drain dressing over the petroleum gauze.	
7.	Place a second sterile precut drain dressing over the first drain dressing with the opening facing in the opposite direction from the first one.	
8.	Place a large drainage dressing over the two precut drain dressing.	

9.	Secure the dressing in place with 2 inches silk tape, making sure to cover dressing completely.	
10.	Write date, time and initial on the dressing.	
11.	Remove personnel protective equipment and wash hands	
12.	Assess patient every 1-2 hours for any changes.	Provides baseline and ongoing assessment of patient condition.
13.	Mark drainage level hourly or per shift on the drainage chamber.	Allows accurate monitoring of drainage amount
14.	Check for air leaks by observing bubbling and occluding tubing.	
15.	Keep drainage tubing free of dependent loops.	Ensures unobstructed drainage and proper lung pressure.
16.	Observe tidaling/fluctuations in the water-seal chamber with respirations.	Indicates lung expansion .
17.	Inspect insertion site daily for crepitus, infection, and skin condition; change dressings when soiled.	Prevents infection and detects tube problems.
18.	Keep system upright and below chest level during ambulation/transport; avoid clamping tube.	
19.	Assess pain and administer analgesia as prescribed.	Manages patient comfort.
20.1	Obtain drainage specimen aseptically if needed.	Provides sample for laboratory analysis.

